Gideon Moore

PhD Student, Stanford Economics
Fields: Labor and Industrial Organization
Citizenship: United States

gsmoore@stanford.edu
www.gideonmoore.com

EDUCATION

Stanford University — Stanford, CA
PhD, Economics — *2022–Anticipated 2028*
Committee: Nicholas Bloom, Liran Einav, Isaac Sorkin, and Shoshana Vasserman

Bowdoin College — Brunswick, ME
AB, Magna Cum Laude, High Honors — *2015–2019*
Economics and Mathematics, Minor Computer Science
Advisor: John Fitzgerald

EXPERIENCE

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) — Stanford, CA
Predoctoral Fellow with Heidi Williams — *2019–2022*

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston — Boston, MA
Research Intern with Ali Ozdagli — *Summers 2017 and 2018*

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) — Spring 2026
Patricia Liu and Kenneth McKenna Fellow

Social Science Prediction Platform — Spring 2025
#1 Most Accurate Forecaster

Stanford Department of Economics — Fall 2024
Teaching Award

Bowdoin College Department of Economics — Spring 2019
1897 Noyes Prize in Political Economy

Phi Beta Kappa — Spring 2019
Member

WORKING PAPERS

Target What? The Foundations of Poverty Targeting — November 2026
Rema Hanna, Emily Breza, Benjamin A. Olken, Abhijit Banerjee, Arun G. Chandrasekhar, and me (r) — *NBER WP 35984*

Abstract: Most government transfer programs aim to target the poor. Doing so implicitly assumes that the lowest-consumption households have the highest marginal social valuation, i.e., have the highest social welfare gain from an additional dollar. But this need not be the case. In 600 Indonesian villages, we ask over 5,500 villagers to rank other villagers on how well off they are

and how much a modest cash transfer would help them, and compare these rankings to consumption and self-assessed welfare. Targeting consumption misses 77% of households with the highest marginal social valuation. Targeting self-assessed welfare misses 57%. Even targeting those the community ranks worst off in levels, not margins, misses 25%. Divergences between different notions of neediness are statistically predictable. In a randomized controlled trial, proxy means tests best target consumption, self-targeting ordeals capture self-assessed welfare levels, and community targeting comes closest to marginal social valuation. Targeting strategies inescapably embed normative stances.

The Political Content of College Courses — August 2026
With Jacob Light and Samuel Thau — *SIEPR Working Paper 26-19*

Abstract: We measure two dimensions of politics in college courses - the amount of political content and its partisan orientation - using course descriptions from nearly 1,000 U.S. colleges and universities over the past 25 years. Using a novel text-as-data method, we separate the amount of "political content," the extent to which a course engages with topics salient to politics and public policy, from "slant," the partisan direction of that content. Since 2000, the average course has 0.15 SD more political content and 0.13 SD more liberal slant. Changes are most pronounced in the tails of the distribution, particularly for slant, and are modest relative to persistent cross-field differences. Following instructors who move between institutions, we find that instructors account for 60-65% of cross-sectional differences in course political content and slant. Using enrollment data, we find students show no preference for liberal content before the 2010s; demand for liberal content rises over the following decade, peaks in 2020, and falls slightly thereafter.

Time Travel on Professional Profiles — July 2026
With Nicholas Bloom, Lisa K. Simon, and Caelan Wilkie-Rogers — *NBER WP 35546*

Abstract: Economists increasingly use professional profile data to reconstruct employment histories and measure skill supply. We show that these records are not fixed historical snapshots, but mutable accounts that workers revise over time. Using monthly vintages of Revelio Labs data from 2020–2026, we document that 19.7 percent of established U.S. LinkedIn users retroactively edit the title or description of a job they have already left. These "time-travel" edits are closely tied to labor market transitions: around such edits, workers are much more likely to change employers as compared to later-editing users. This mutability can bias historical measures of skills, but it also reveals workers' beliefs about which skills are in demand. Retroactive edits show sharp post-2022 increases in AI-related language and recent reductions in work-from-home and DEI language. Finally, LLM-associated writing markers surge after ChatGPT, especially among less-educated groups and MBAs from lower-ranked programs, revealing heterogeneous AI-assisted profile editing.

Medicare Home Health Fraud: How Much, Where, and Who? — June 2026
With Liran Einav, Amy Finkelstein, Yunan Ji, and Neale Mahoney — *NBER WP 35280*

Abstract: How much fraud is there in Medicare and who commits it? We provide an answer for Medicare home health, a setting widely considered especially rife with fraud. We define a home health agency (HHA) as fraudulent if it was prosecuted by a federal strike force. Combining Medicare claims data on all HHAs with hand-collected prosecution records from the nine federal judicial districts where strike forces operated between 2009 and 2013, we train a machine learning model to predict, out of sample, the probability that each HHA in the remaining 85 districts would have been prosecuted had a strike force been present. We estimate that in 2008, 3.4% of Medicare home health spending – about $520 million – was billed by fraudulent HHAs. The strike forces were well-targeted: their nine districts contained only 40% of home health spending but 65% of

fraudulent spending. Fraudulent HHAs display intuitive characteristics: they are more likely to rely on extremely high-volume referring physicians, to exhibit unusually uniform patterns of care, and to serve healthier-than-average patients.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Learning-by-Doing and the Life Cycle of Innovation
With Janet Stefanov and Samuel Thau

Abstract: Orville and Wilbur Wright developed their famous glider while working as bicycle repairmen—despite neither finishing high school. Today, innovations in flight are not so easy to come by: in 2025 Lockheed Martin employed more than 30,000 PhDs as part of the nearly 2 billion dollars it spends on research each year. We show this shift—from practitioner learning-by-doing to dedicated research—is emblematic of a broader "life cycle" of innovation within an industry. Using a novel text-as-data method to identify idea sources based on patent content, we document a decline in learning-by-doing both within and across fields from 1976-2010; this trend has reversed in recent years. Motivated by this fact, we develop a novel growth model incorporating both sources of innovation. This model implies optimal innovation policy depends on the maturity of an industry: young industries benefit from procurement policies which harness the benefits of learning-by-doing, while more mature industries warrant more dedicated R&D subsidies.

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

Department of Economics Seminar, Bowdoin College	October 2026
NBER Health Care Administration and Fraud Conference	October 2026
Allied Social Science Associations Annual Meeting	January 2026
All-California Labor Economics Conference	August 2025

SERVICE

Stanford-Spelman Mentoring Partnership *Mentor*	2022–2026
Stanford Applied Job Market Showcase *Founding Co-Organizer*	Fall 2024
Stanford Applied Lunch Seminar *Co-Organizer*	2024–2025
Economics Graduate Student Council *Member*	2022–2024

TEACHING

Principles of Economics TA *With Pete Klenow, John Taylor, and Isaac Sorkin*	Stanford University *Fall 2024–Fall 2025*
PhD Macroeconomics Tutor *With Monika Piazzesi and Martin Schneider*	Stanford University *Fall 2024*

Last updated: November 9, 2026